# Before you hire an app developer: 12 questions to answer first

A free checklist from Salmen Khelifi. Answer these on paper, then talk to any developer.

> **How to use it:** answer each question in one or two sentences. If you can't answer one, that is the first thing to discuss with your developer. Send your answers to me and I will tell you honestly if the project fits, what it should cost to scope, and what to cut first.

## Part 1. Who and why

1. **Who is the app for?** Describe one real person, not "everyone". What do they do in a normal day?
2. **What problem does it solve for them?** One sentence, no feature names.
3. **What happens in the first 60 seconds?** What does a new user see, tap and get?
4. **How will you know it worked?** Pick one number (sign-ups, bookings, repeat users, revenue).

## Part 2. What gets built

5. **What is the smallest version you would be happy to launch?** List at most five features. Everything else is version 2.
6. **Which platforms first: iPhone, Android or both?** And why? (If you don't know, say so.)
7. **Do users need accounts?** What do they sign in with: email, phone, Apple, Google?
8. **What data does it store, and who can see whose data?** (This is where most apps get it wrong.)
9. **What does it connect to?** Payments, maps, notifications, WhatsApp, your existing website or systems.

## Part 3. After launch

10. **Who maintains it next year?** Bug fixes, store updates, new phone versions, server costs.
11. **Who handles store review and support?** Apple and Google review every release; someone must answer user questions.
12. **What is your budget range and your deadline?** And which one matters more if you must choose?

## Red flags in any quote

- No questions asked before the price.
- "Both platforms, no problem" without a reason.
- Nothing about launch, maintenance or who owns the code.

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**Next step:** send me your answers (or just the questions you can't answer): khelifi-salmen.com. I read every message and reply honestly, including when the answer is "you don't need an app yet".

Salmen Khelifi. Full-stack developer working in Flutter, React Native, Next.js and Node.js.